

L2A™

Q6. (a) What is Cognitive Anthropology? Bring out the contribution of Tyler and Conklin in cognitive theories in Anthropology

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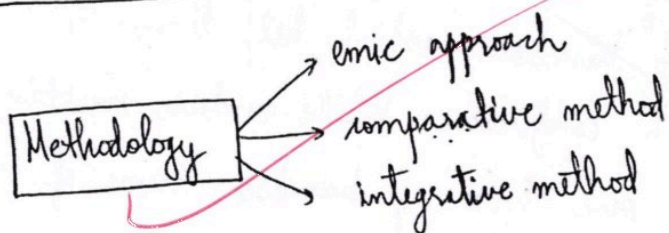
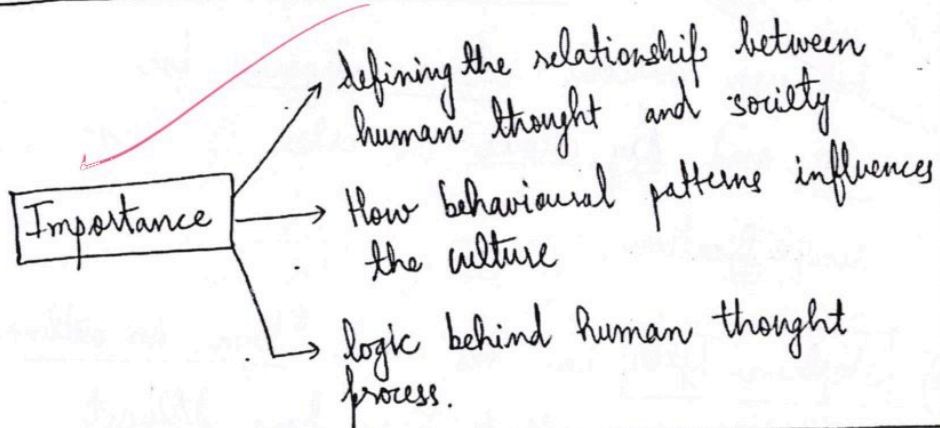
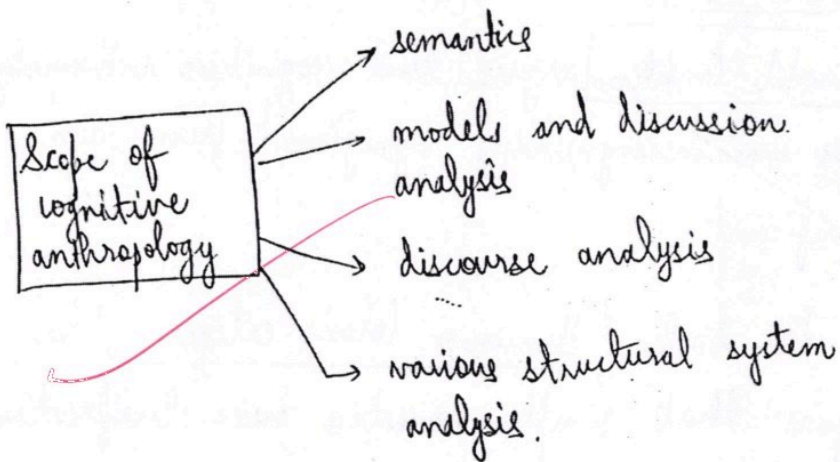
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Cognitive anthropology is an anthropological theory that emerged in 20th century. It is inspired from Sapir-Whorf hypothesis.

Chief proponents - Harold Conklin, Stephen Tyler.

Key concepts

- 1) It aims to study the relation between human mind and cultural change
- 2) It analyses how human mind through its thought process reacts to various changes in society.
- 3) Human mind ~~are~~ processes the ideas that are logical rules and influenced by the human thought process.



Contributions

- 1) Harold Conklin argues that cognitive anthropology helps in distinguishing significant from non significant

In his book 'Hammar colour categories', he argues that simple societies use classification in order to avoid chaos.

They use various colour categories for wet and dry colour in order to have simplification.

- 2) Stephen Tyler in his work 'Koya: An outline grammar' argues that Koya have different categories of bamboos which help them to avoid confusion; While modern societies, have only one type of bamboo, Koyas of South India have various types.

- 3) Kenneth Pike advocated the emic approach in cognitive anthropology.

Criticism

- 1) Malvin Harris argued these theories ~~too~~ are... subjective in nature and very hard to apply.
- 2) They were also criticised of being too abstract
- 3) It is very difficult to reach at generalisations

Despite criticism, cognitive anthropology helped giving a new perspective to anthropological theories ~~through~~ a new dimension of cognition.

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